

Swimming

A reflection

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Preview edition

Chapter 1

Float

To swim first is to float.

Explain notes

- The water is there to help you to swim.

Chapter 2

Relax

Muscles that do not need to be used should be relaxed.

Chapter 3

Meditation

Swimming is meditation.

Chapter 4

Art

Swimming is an art.

Chapter 5

Observe

Observe before entering the water.

Explain notes

- At the beach, observe the waves.
- In a swimming pool, observe the spaces.

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Chapter 6

Steady

There is no swimming fast, but there is swimming steady.

Explain notes

- Do not swim to exhaust your body.
- The best swimming is like having not been swimming.

Chapter 7

Eyes

Should look at the bottom of the water.

Explain notes

- So your neck can be relaxed.
- Prepare for entering into meditation later.

Chapter 8

Suit

Wear a scuba diver suit and you can still swim at a good speed.

Explain notes

- It becomes part of your body.
- It makes you like a balloon, so you float more at the beach, therefore safer.

Chapter 9

Discipline

Swimming is discipline.

Explain notes

- If there is no discipline, you cannot swim.

Chapter 10

Change

Swimming is infinite change.

Chapter 11

Ideas

Swimming is the come and go of ideas.

Chapter 12

Fun

Swimming is about fun.

Explain notes

- Ideas make it fun.
- Can swim alongside others make it fun.

Chapter 13

Feel

Swimming is feeling what the water is like.

Explain notes

- After you feel what the water is like, you can bring the feeling out of the water, for example in speaking, walking, and so on.

Chapter 14

Habit

Swimming is a daily habit.

Explain notes

- It is not passion, because passion cannot be sustained.

Chapter 15

Don't compare

Do not compare with others.

Only compare with yourself.

Chapter 16

Don't stay alert

Better no need to stay alert than have to.

Explain notes

- When you stay alert, you cannot enter the flow state.
- You need to stay alert because you are too close to another swimmer, or because you have not found your way in the water.

Chapter 17

Mistake

*Do not swim longer than needed.
That will make the same mistakes longer.*

Chapter 18

Style

Follow the teachers at the beginning.

Later develop your own style.

Chapter 19

Freestyle

Choose freestyle.

Chapter 20

Breathing

*Breathing on one side.
One breath every four strokes.*

Chapter 21

Hands

Hands can pull back at any time.

Hands can push water to the sides.

The same hand can pull two times in a row.

Chapter 22

Head

Head can come out of the water and look to any side steadily.

Chapter 23

Legs

Legs can stretch out to keep balance.

Chapter 24

Knees

Knees can touch the bottom of the pool.

Chapter 25

Body

The body can tilt upwards.

The body can bend up in the middle.

Explain notes

- Both ways keep the head up, and you can see more above the water.

Chapter 26

Wave

*A hand can also be used to wave above the water
to greet a friend.*

Chapter 27

Toes

Toes can be used to push the lower body up.

Chapter 28

Movement

Movement can become so soft that you do not hurt yourself.

Chapter 29

Circles

Try to swim in small circles at the beach.

Chapter 30

Lane

In a swimming pool, you do not have to hold a lane.

Explain notes

- You can swim left or right and find your lane within the spaces.
- It will eventually be your lane when you follow the same path, even if it is not a straight line.

Chapter 31

Guard

*When you have to guard, guard with your hands
and leave some space.*

Chapter 32

Pass

When a faster swimmer is passing you, let them pass.

Explain notes

- Because you have triggered the passion within them.
- Keep your peace.

Chapter 33

Enter

*Look at the bottom of the pool and enter into
meditation.*